

Electronic Materials and Devices

MOSFETs

Metal-oxide-semiconductor
field-effect transistors

Dr. Zahraa Ismail

Computer Engineering · Academic Year 2025/2026 · Semester One

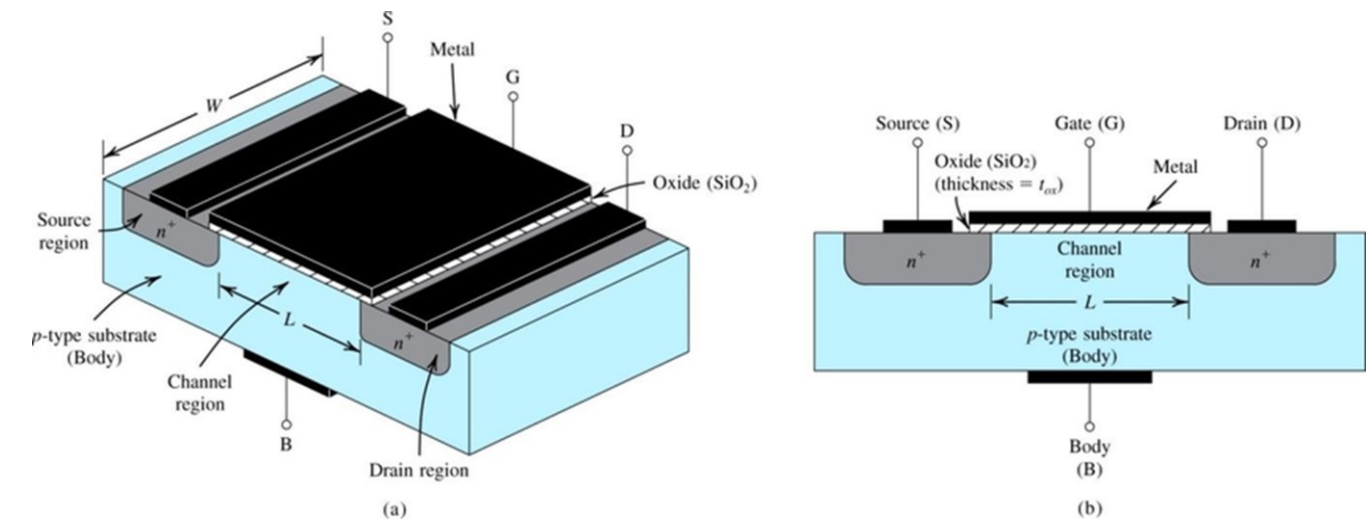
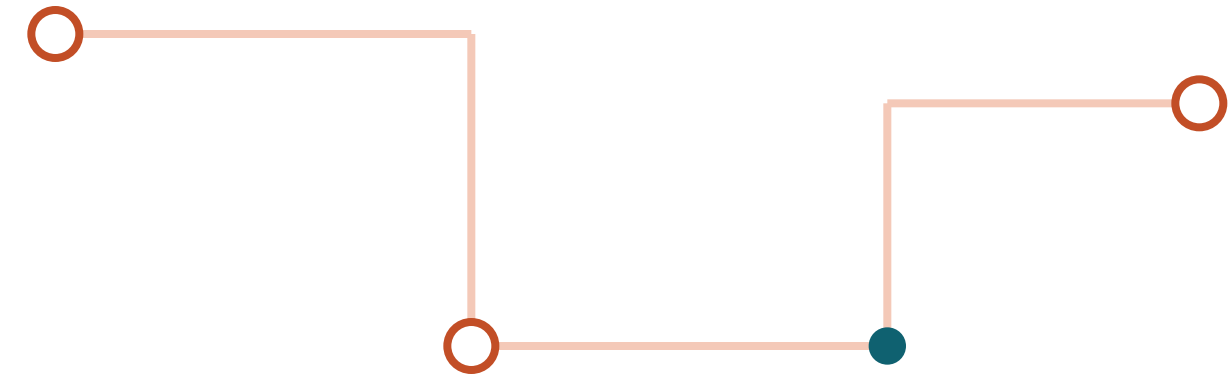


Figure: Sedra & Smith, Microelectronic Circuits

Lecture map

01

Structure and operation

how a channel forms; the threshold voltage



02

I–V characteristics

cutoff, triode and saturation



03

MOSFETs in DC circuits

finding the operating point



04

The MOSFET as an amplifier

transconductance, small-signal model



05

The MOSFET as a switch



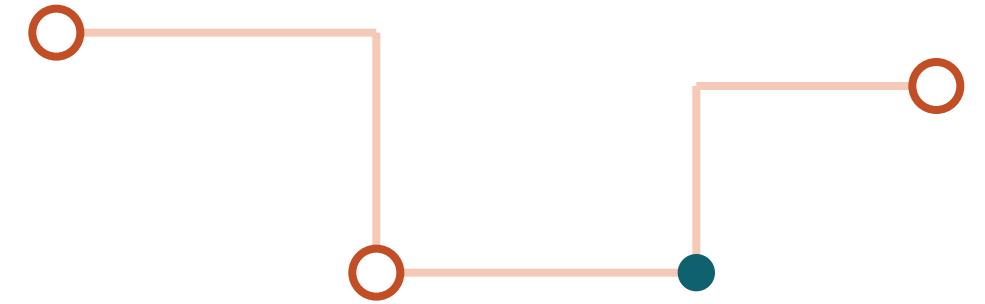
By the end you can

- Explain how v_{GS} creates a channel and how v_{DS} pinches it off
- Pick the right region and use its i_D equation
- Find the DC operating point of a MOSFET circuit

2

I–V characteristics

- Increasing v_{DS} : pinch-off
- Triode and saturation
- The i_D – v_{DS} family of curves



1 Structure and operation

2 I–V characteristics

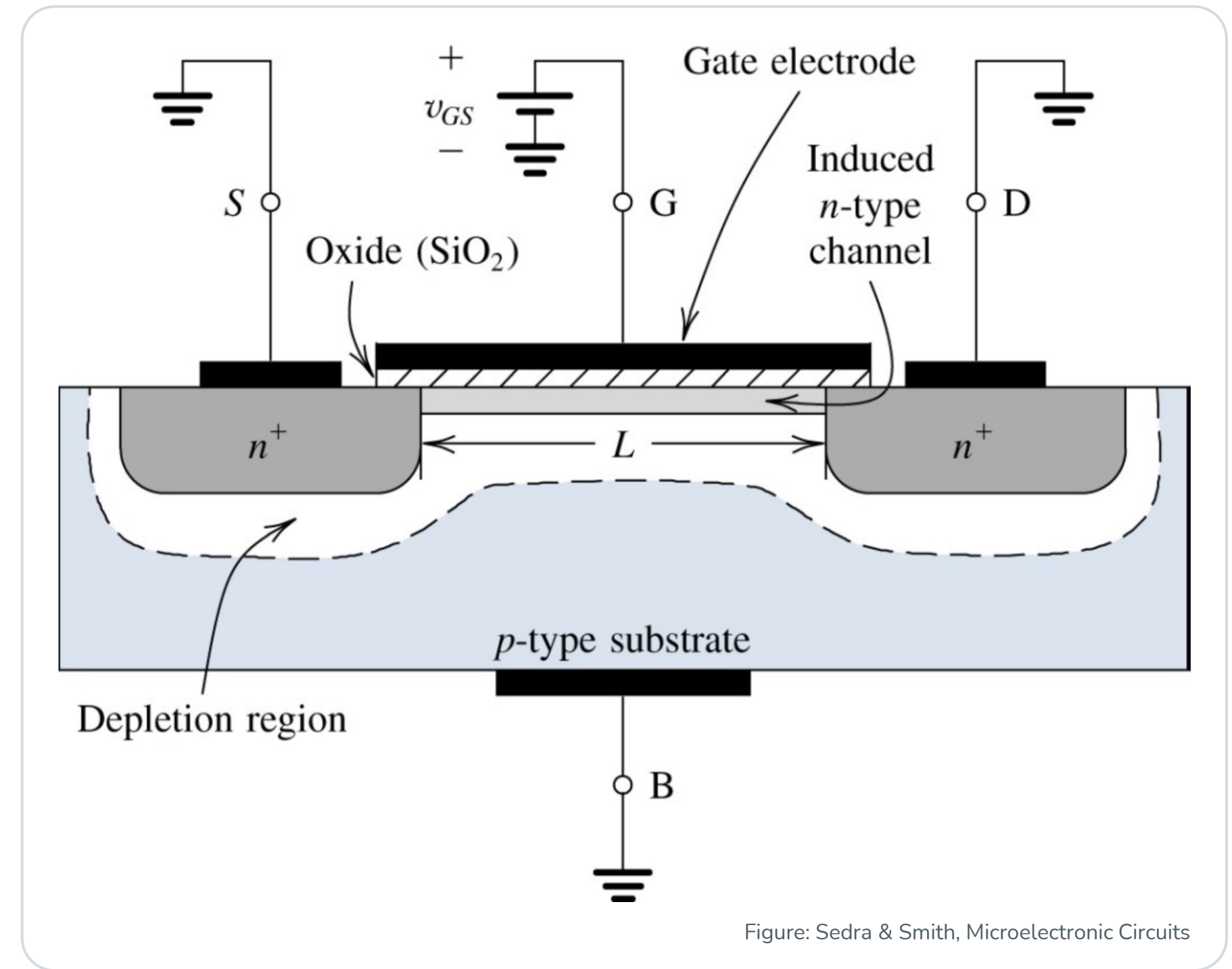
3 MOSFETs in DC circuits

4 The MOSFET as an amplifier

5 The MOSFET as a switch

Creating a channel: the threshold voltage

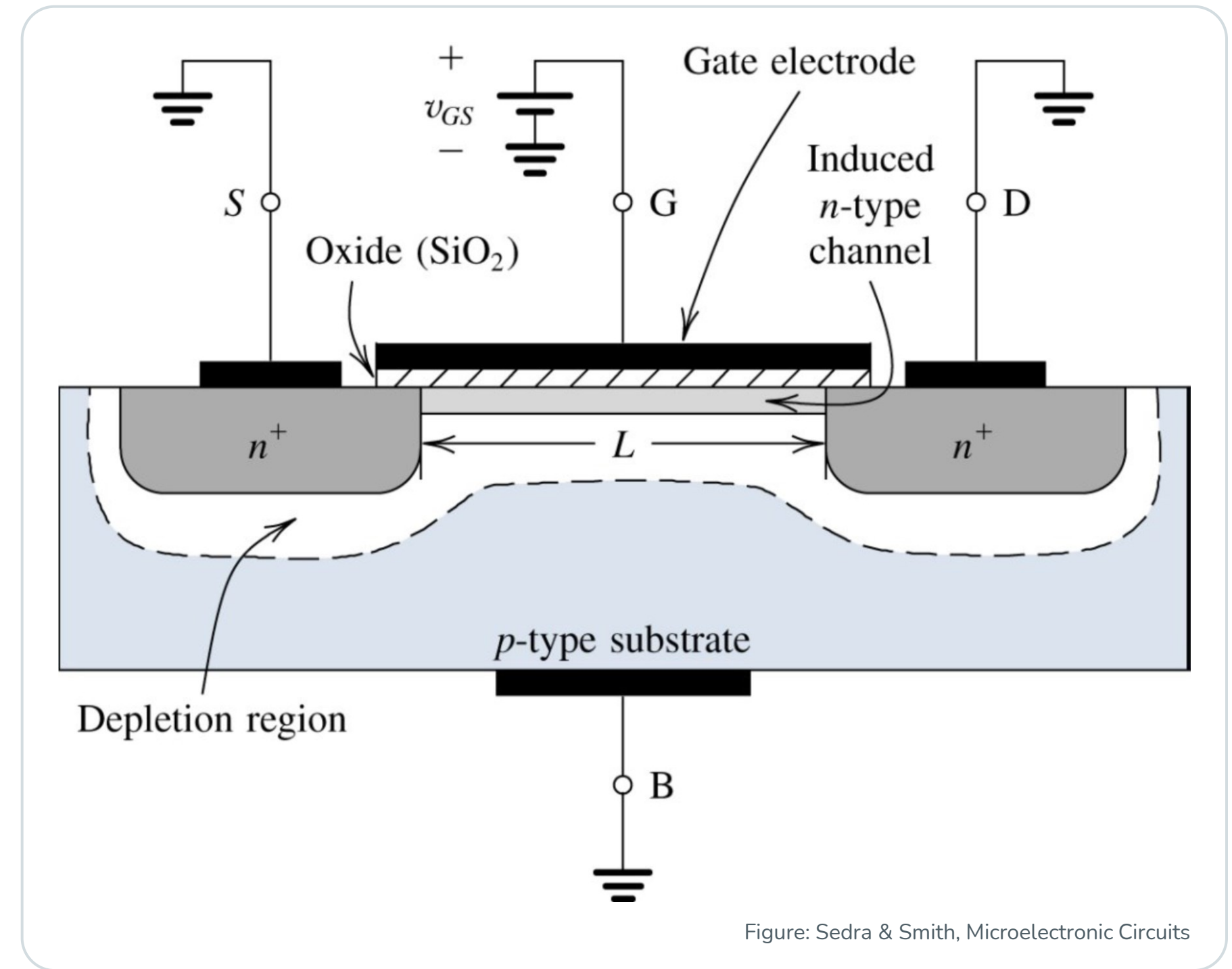
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Once enough electrons gather, they form an n -type **inversion layer**: the channel that links source to drain.



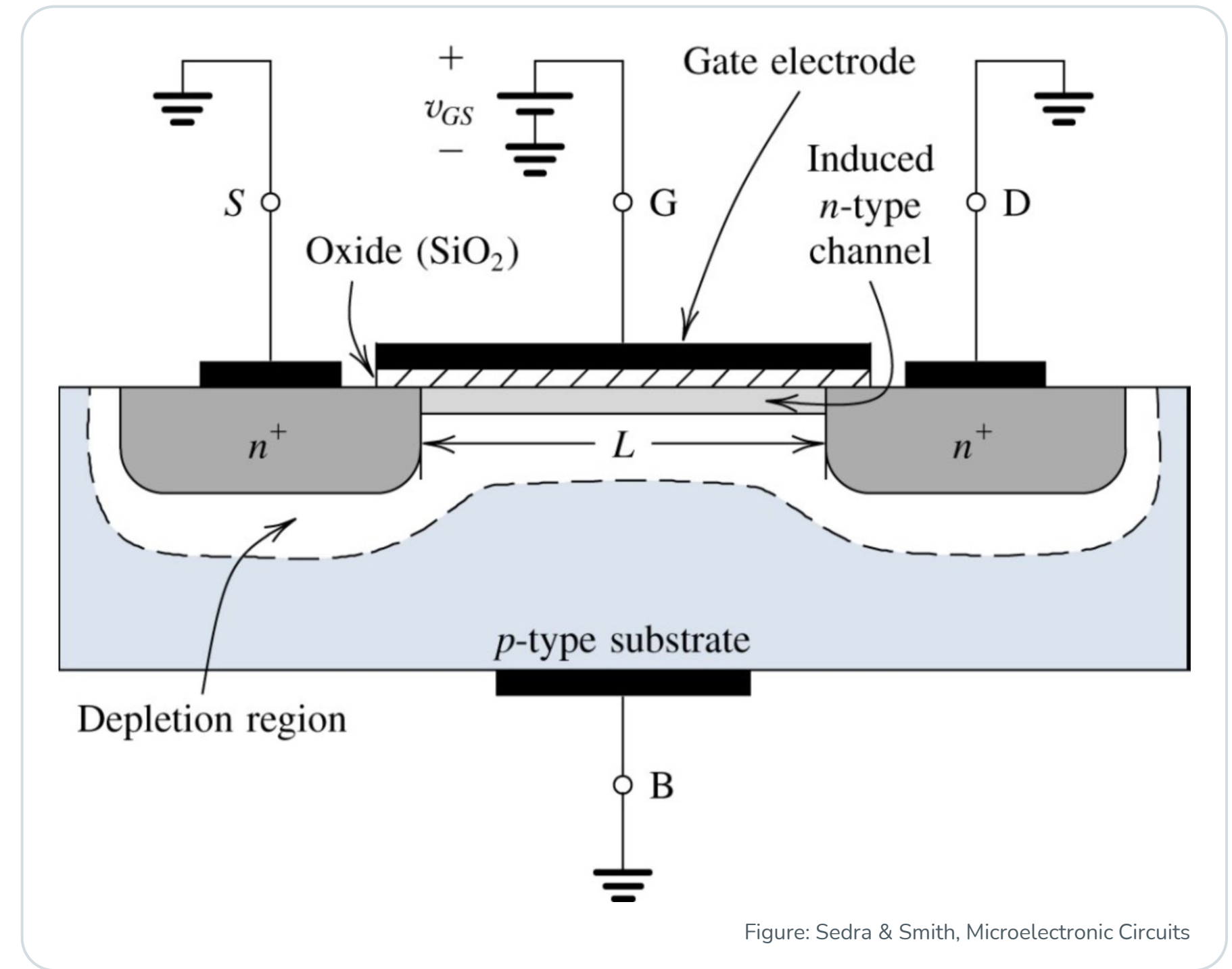
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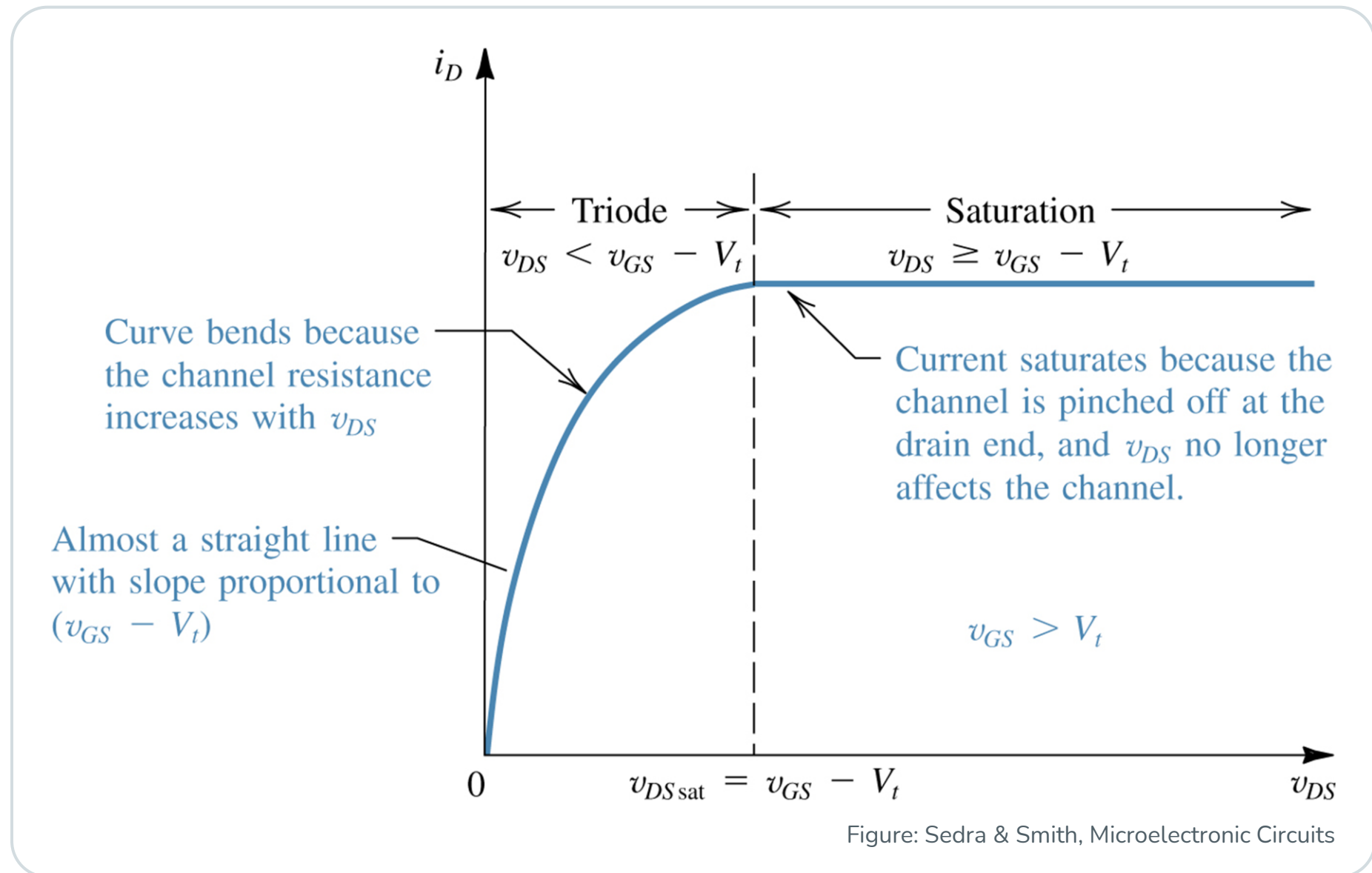
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Definition

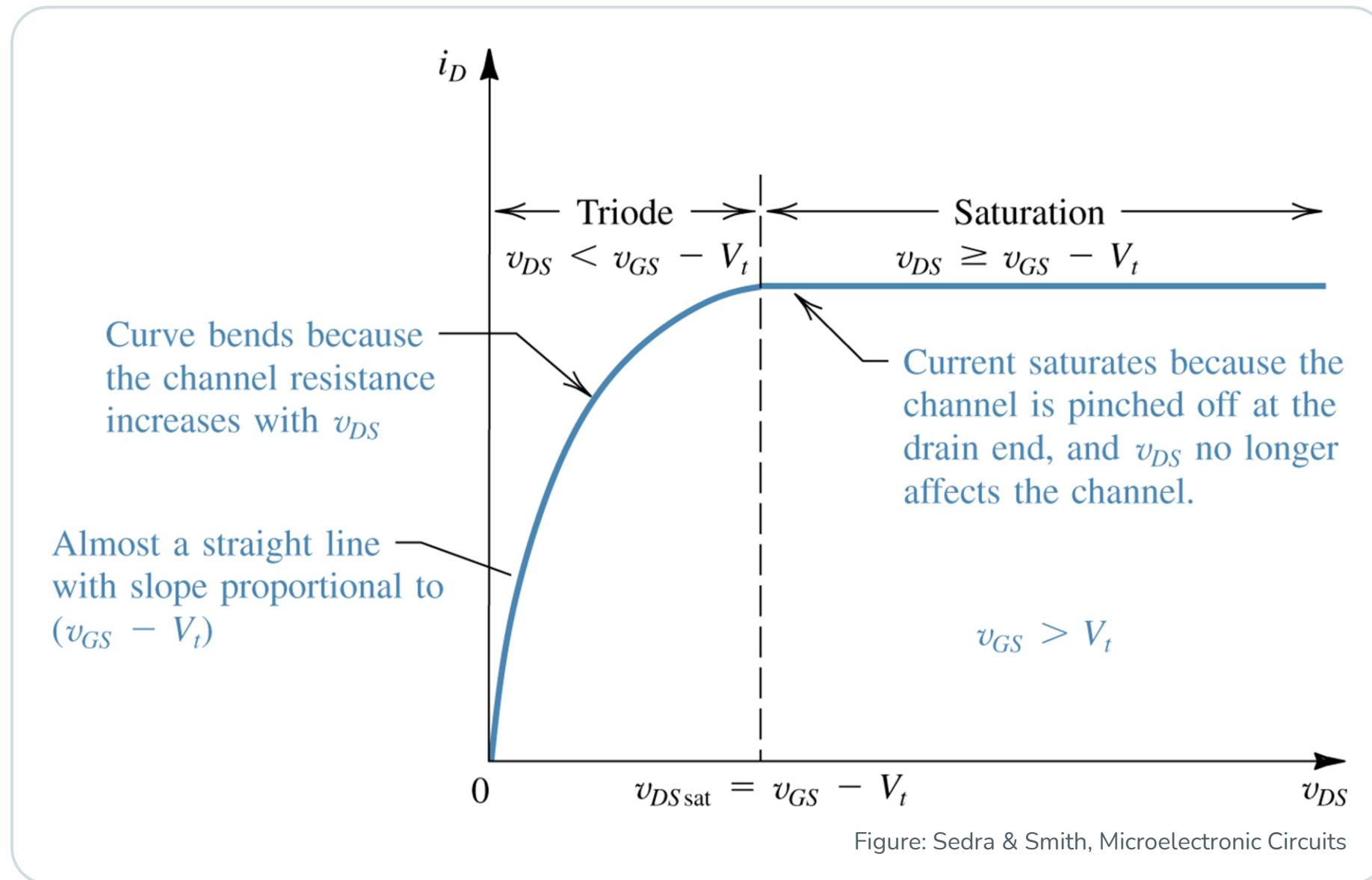
Threshold voltage V_t : the value of v_{GS} at which the channel just forms.



Triode and saturation: one curve, two equations



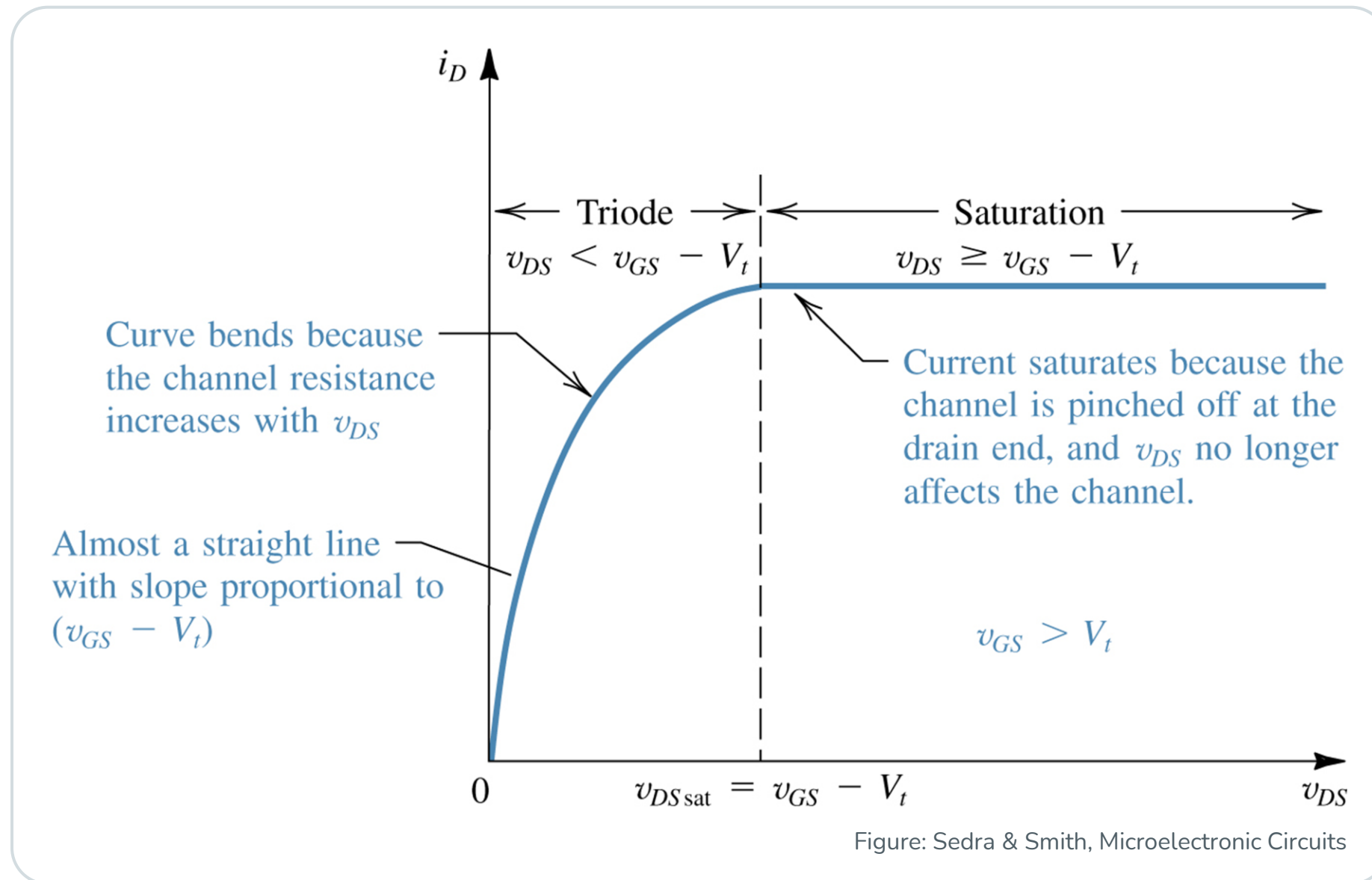
Triode and saturation: one curve, two equations

**Triode**

$$v_{DS} < v_{GS} - V_t$$

$$i_D = k'_n \frac{W}{L} \left[(v_{GS} - V_t) v_{DS} - \frac{1}{2} v_{DS}^2 \right]$$

Triode and saturation: one curve, two equations



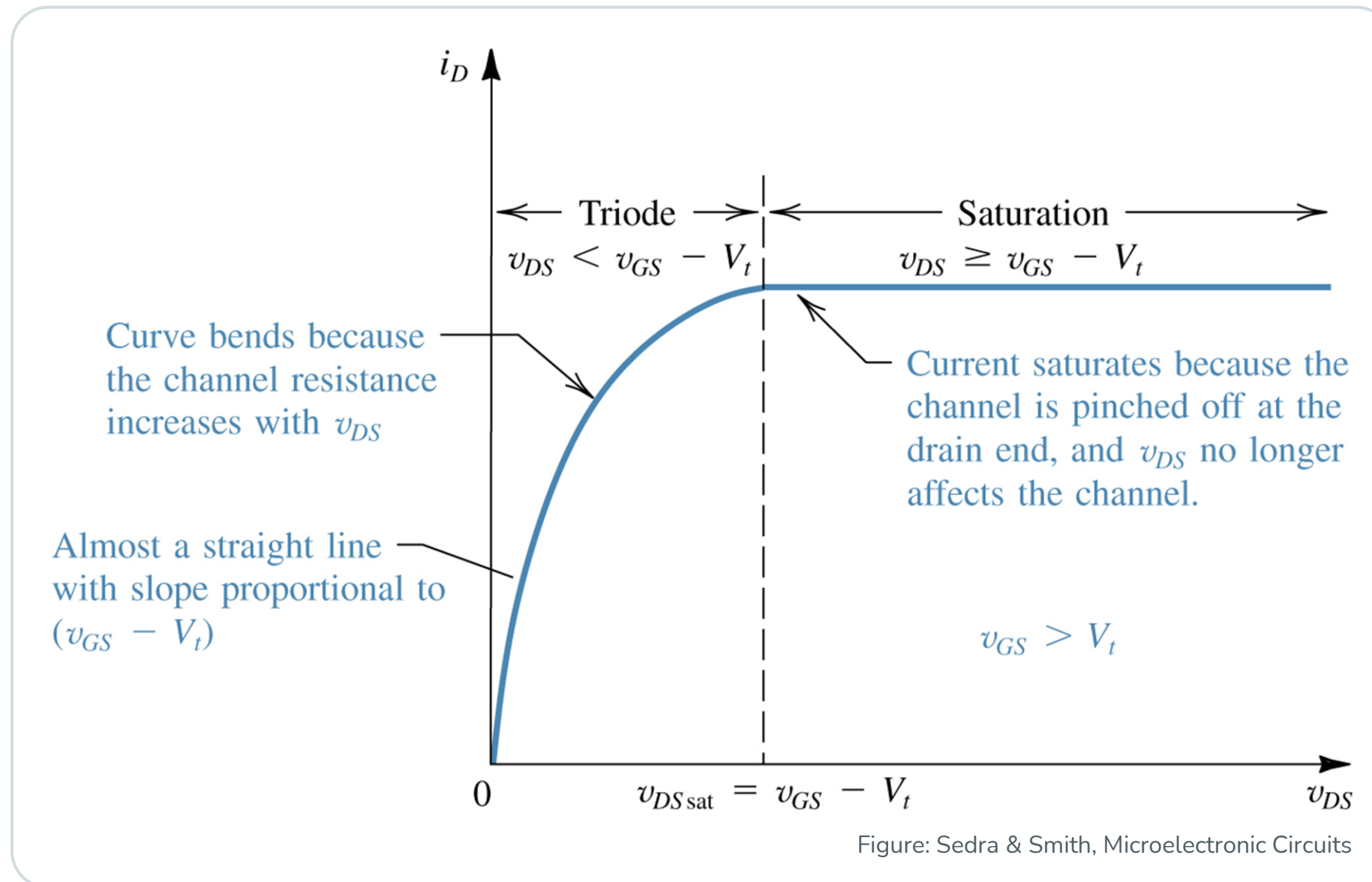
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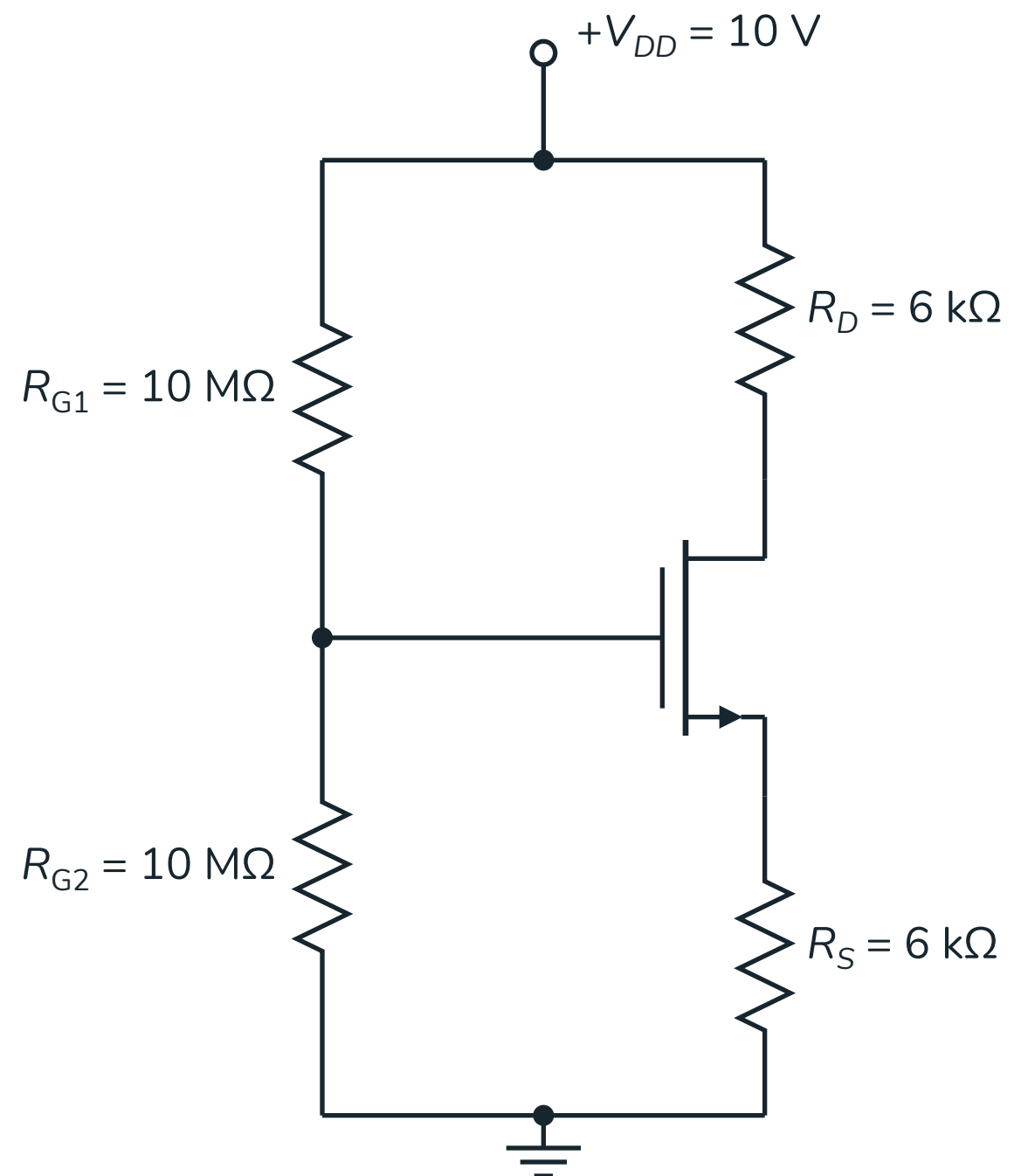
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Both require $v_{GS} > V_t$: without a channel, $i_D = 0$ (cutoff).

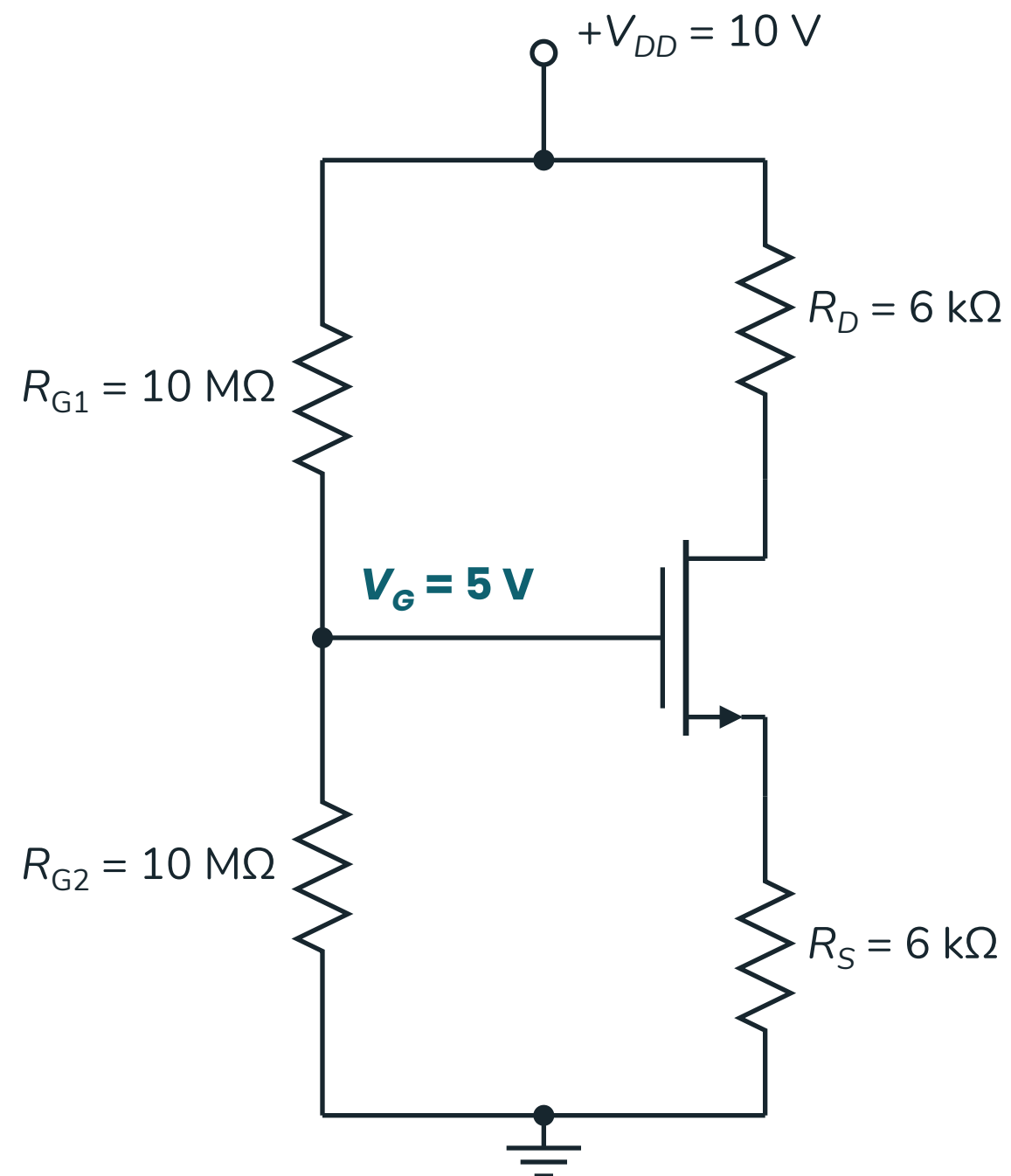
Example: find the drain voltage

Given $V_t = 1 \text{ V}$ and $k'_n(W/L) = 1 \text{ mA/V}^2$. The gate draws no current.



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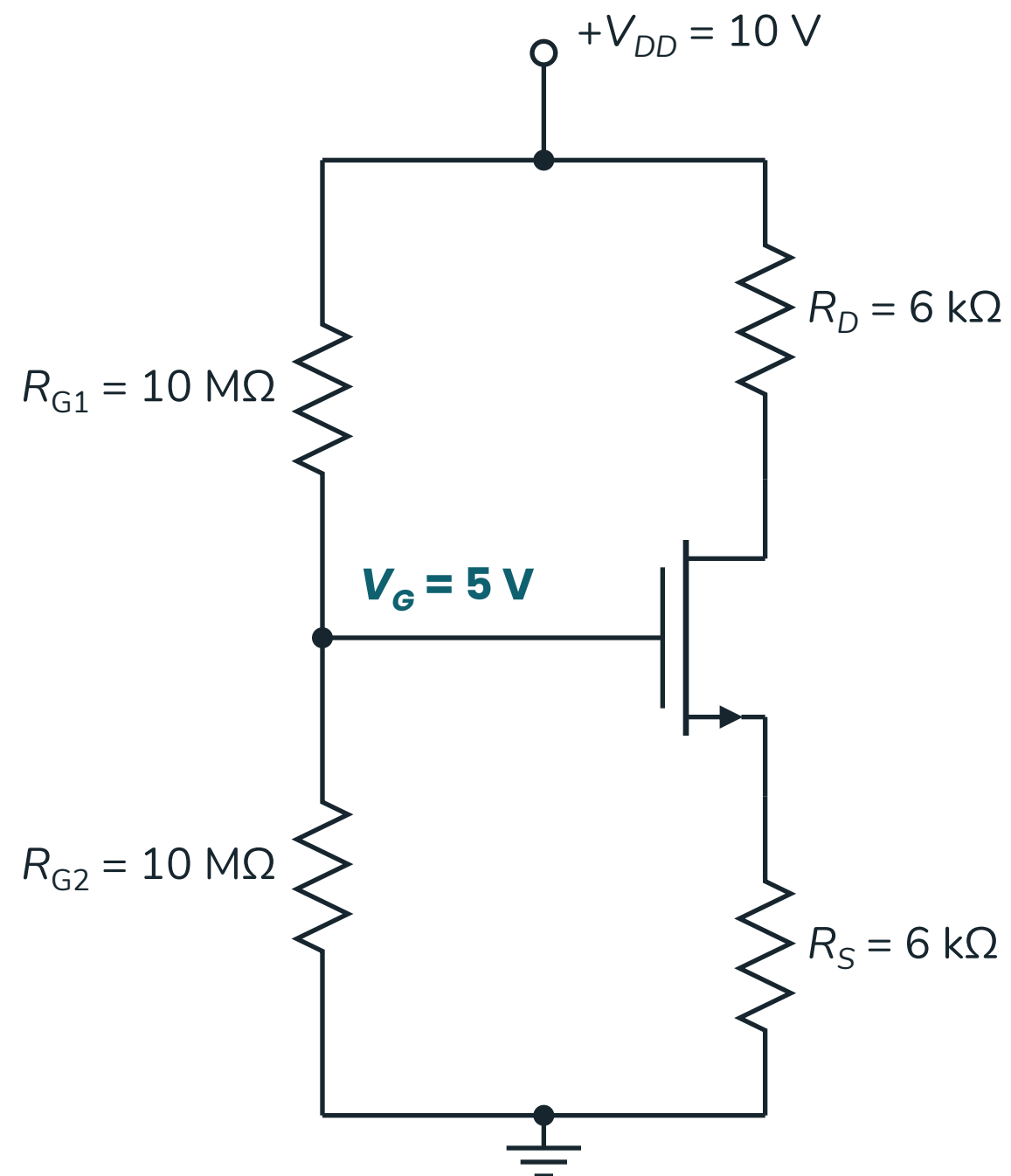


1 Gate voltage: the divider is unloaded

$$V_G = V_{DD} \frac{R_{G2}}{R_{G1} + R_{G2}} = 5 \text{ V}$$

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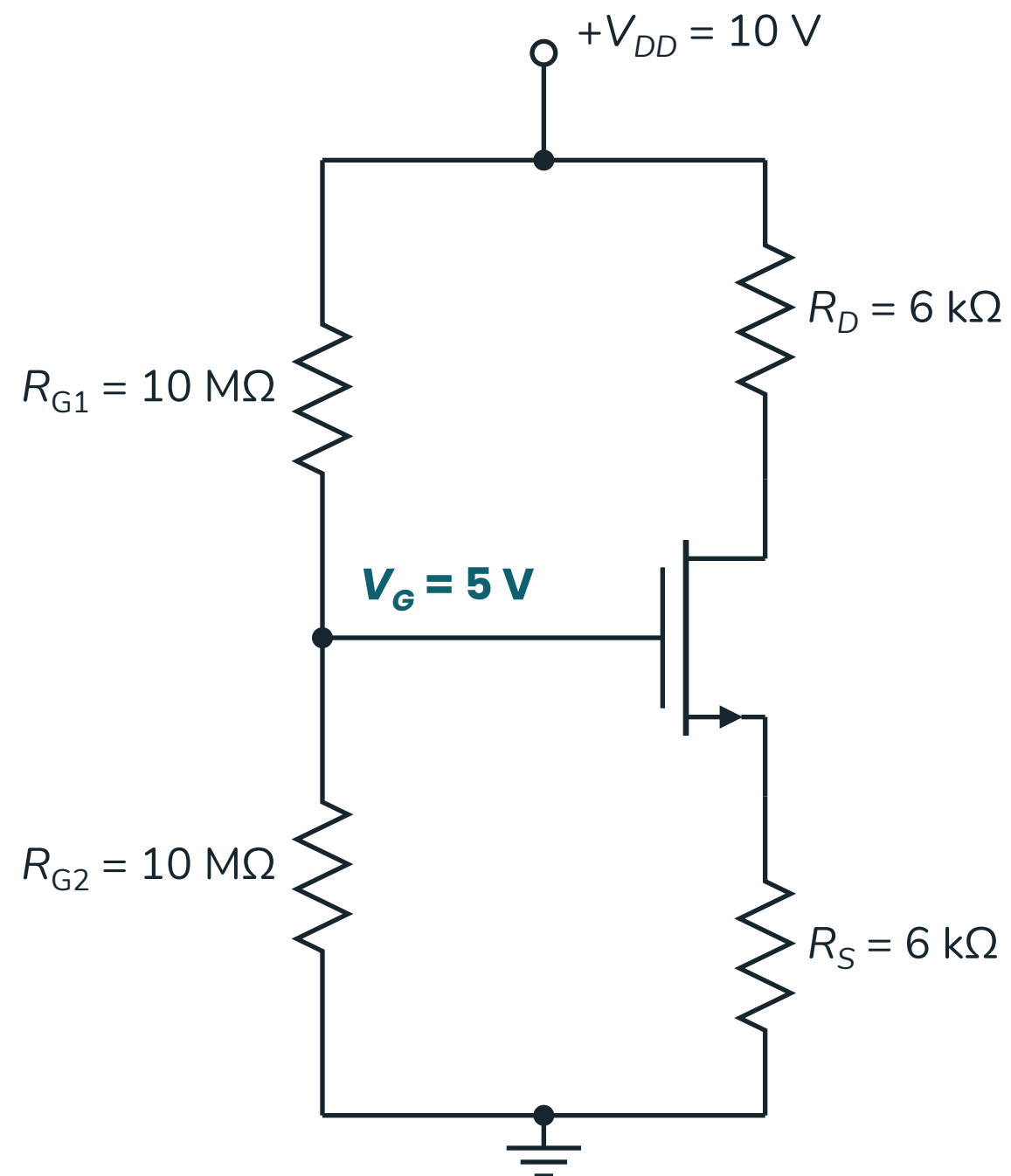
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- 2 Assume saturation, with $V_{GS} = V_G - I_D R_S$ (I in mA, R in kΩ)

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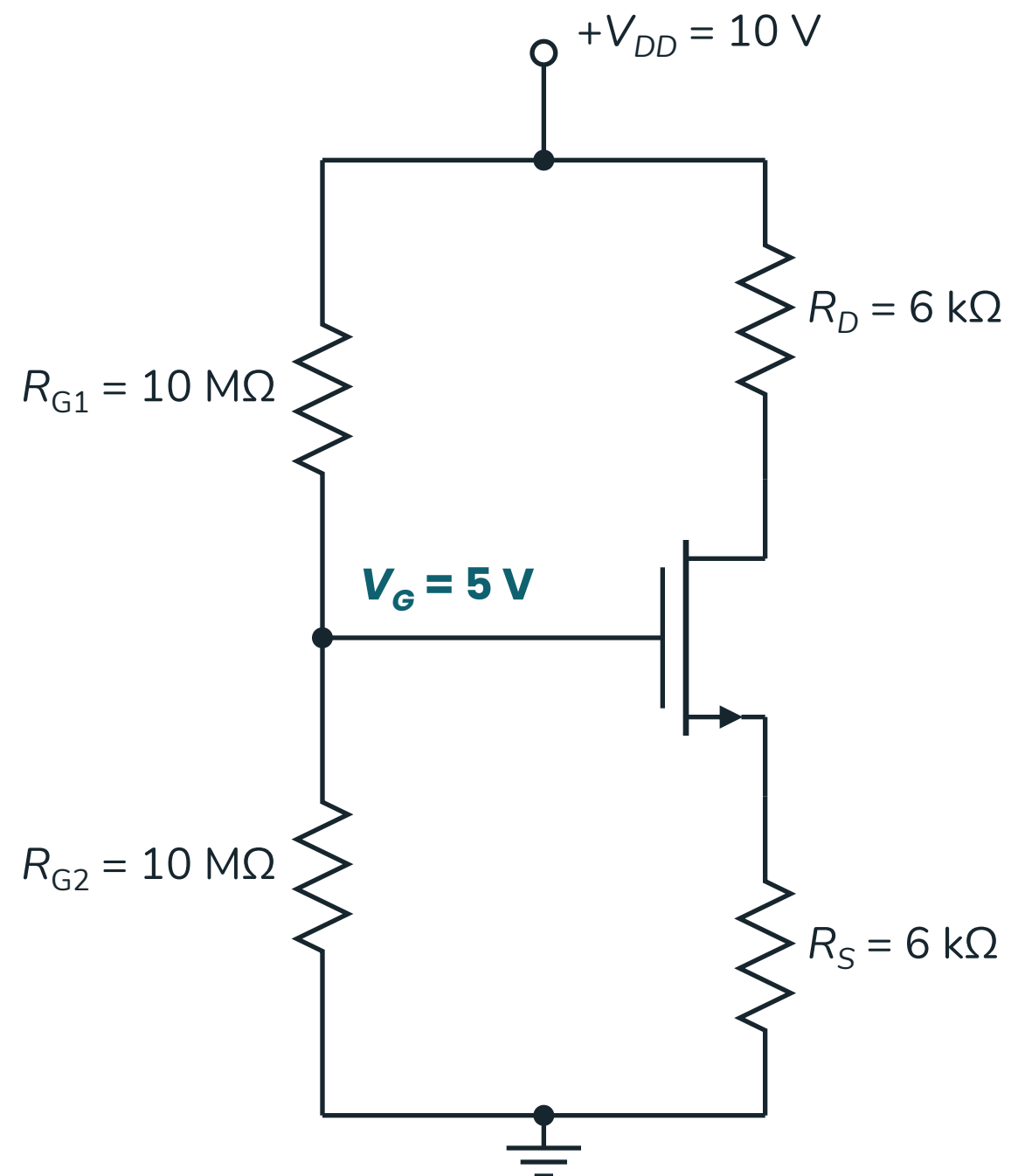
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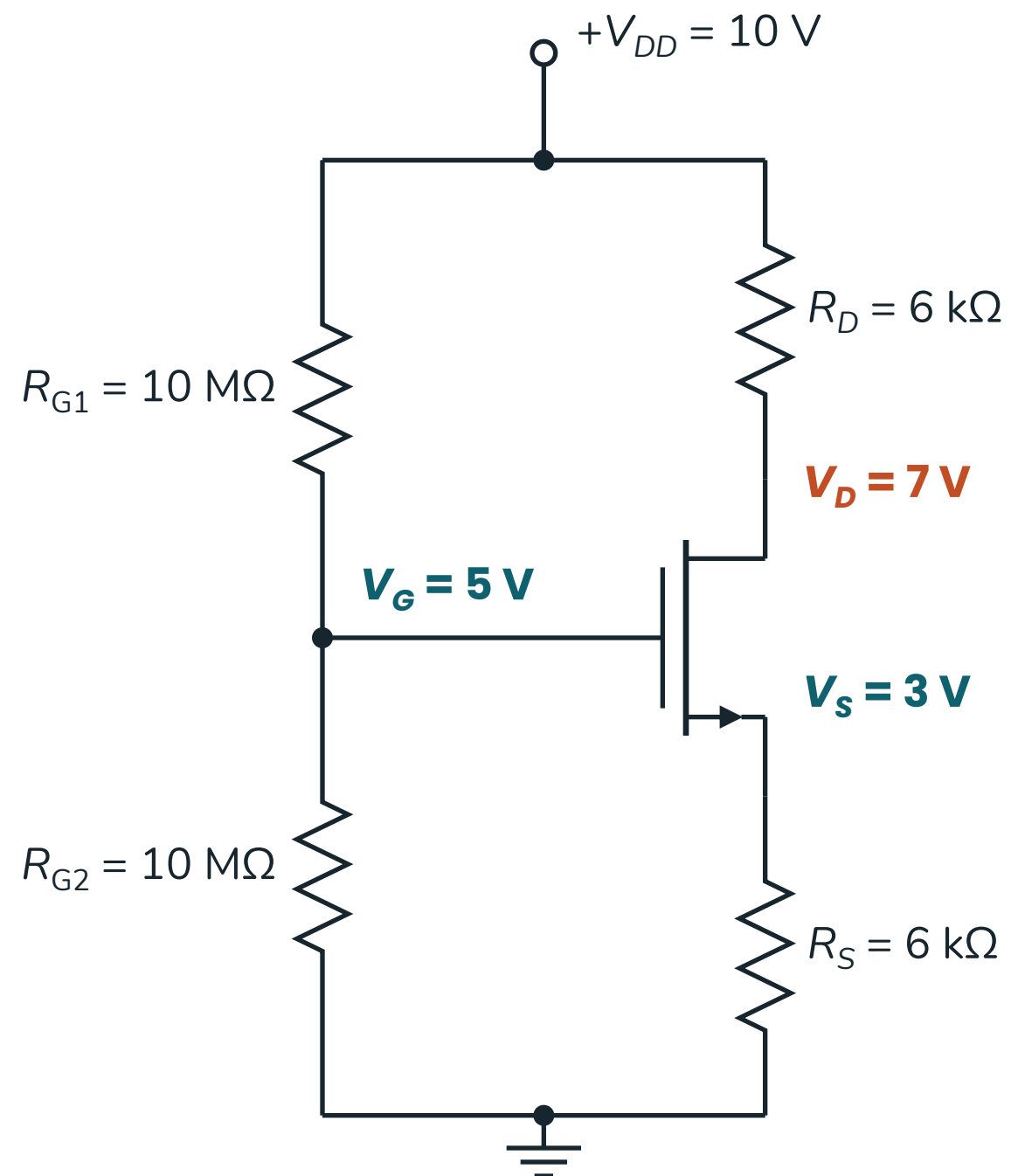
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- 5 $V_D = V_{DD} - I_D R_D = 10 - 0.5(6) = 7 \text{ V}$

$$V_D = 7 \text{ V}$$

✓ $V_{DS} = 4 \text{ V} \geq V_{GS} - V_t = 1 \text{ V}$: saturation holds.

Summary: three regions of operation

Region	Condition	Drain current
Cutoff	$v_{GS} \leq V_t$	$i_D = 0$
Triode	$v_{GS} > V_t, v_{DS} < v_{GS} - V_t$	$i_D = k'_n \frac{W}{L} \left[(v_{GS} - V_t) v_{DS} - \frac{1}{2} v_{DS}^2 \right]$
Saturation	$v_{GS} > V_t, v_{DS} \geq v_{GS} - V_t$	$i_D = \frac{1}{2} k'_n \frac{W}{L} (v_{GS} - V_t)^2$

- In a DC problem: **assume** a region, **solve**, then **check** the assumption.
- Current saturates because the channel is pinched off at the drain end.